

MS Excel

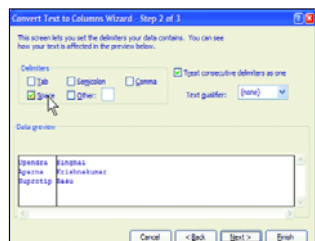
Rows to Column or Vice-versa

If you want to interchange the data in rows to columns and vice-versa, select the cells containing the data and press [CTRL] + [C] to copy them to the clipboard. Now click the first cell where you want to paste the data and go to **Edit > Paste Special**. In the dialog, enable the checkmark **Transpose** and click OK to paste.

Separating Last Name and First

If you have a field that contains entire names, but what you need instead is two fields containing the first name and last name separately, use the **Convert Text to Column Wizard**.

To access this wizard, select the data and then click **Data > Text to Column**. In the first screen of the three-step wizard, you will be asked to choose if your data type is 'Delimited', or 'fixed width'. Check the choice applicable and click **Next**. In the next screen, if your data type is 'Delimited' choose the appropriate



Separating firstname and lastname using the text to column wizard

delimiter or the character that separates the first and last names, and then click OK. In the final step, select the destination box and click the destination cell, and finally, click **Finish**.

If you are feeling adventurous, you could try either for the following two commands:

1. `=LEFT(A1,FIND(",",A1)-1)` assuming the name is in cell A1 and the first name and last name are separated by a comma.

2. `=MID(A1,FIND(",",A1)+2,255)` to extract last name.

Want a Special Character?

The characters * or ' and ? have special meaning in Excel. To locate them in your Excel file, use the **Find and Replace** dialog under 'Edit'. Prefix them with a '~' in the 'Find' field and search. For example, if you want to find a ?, enter '~?' in the find dialog.

Freeze the Title Row

Use the **Window > Freeze Panes** menu item to lock

1. Enter the data in one sheet, copy and then paste into other sheets.

2. Press and hold the [CTRL] key and click on the sheet names near the status bar. One you have selected the sheets, enter data on the sheet that is visible and it will be entered to all sheets. Similarly, you can use the [CTRL] key to select multiple sheets and then do many other things, like running the spell checker.

marks entered are within the specified range. To set validation rules for this example, select the cells and go to **Data > Validation**. On the **Settings** tab, in the **Allow** list, choose 'decimal'. In the **Data** list, select 'between'. In the **Minimum** and **Maximum** fields, enter 0 and 100 respectively. On the **Input message** tab, you can specify what message to display at the time of entering data in those cells. This message comes similar to the tool tips and is unobtrusive. On the **Error Alert** tab, you can specify the message to display a wrong value is entered. Finally, click OK.

MS Word

Remove the Drawing Canvas

In Word 2002 and later, whenever you insert a drawing object, a drawing canvas is placed around it. It was introduced to help you arrange the drawings in the document. If you prefer working without it, you can turn it off. One way is to drag the drawing object out of the canvas, selecting the canvas and then deleting it using the [DEL] key. There is a way to turn it off permanently, too. Go to **Tools > Options** and switch to the **General** tab. Here, clear the checkbox that says 'Automatically create drawing canvas when inserting AutoShapes'.

Change blank paragraphs at the end of the page

If a page ends with a table, a drawing object (such as a text box or text frame) or a continuous section break, it will be followed by a blank paragraph. This paragraph may force your document to jump onto another page. To keep your document on one page, format the blank paragraph:

1. Make the paragraph symbols visible by pressing [CTRL]+[SHIFT]+[8].
2. Select the paragraph symbol you want to change.
3. On the **Format** menu, click **Font** and then click the **Font** tab.
4. Type 1 in the **Size** box, and click OK.

Tips Tricks

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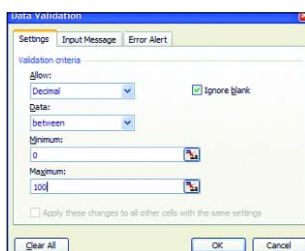
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Using Validation Rules

You can limit the data that can be entered in



Creating rules for data entry

cells. For example, you can create a rule for entering students' marks, so that the